



UNIVERSITY OF EDUCATION, WINNEBA
DEPARTMENT OF ICT EDUCATION
POST-INTERNSHIP TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

NAME: BAAH EZEKIEL

INDEX NUMBER: 5231570002

STATEMENT OF TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

I believe students learn ICT by doing it, not by hearing about it. My job is to demonstrate a skill clearly, then step back quickly and let students build it themselves on something that means something to them, whether that is their own name in a PowerPoint slide or their family's budget in Excel. Everyone in the room should be able to follow, regardless of how fast they type, how many students are sharing a laptop, or how confident they are to begin with.

VALIDITY OF TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

This is not a new idea. Piaget and Vygotsky both argued that learners build understanding through activity and guided support rather than by being told. Dewey and Kolb describe learning as a cycle that has to pass through real experience to stick. Differentiated instruction and Universal Design for Learning support the second half of the belief, that a single explanation pitched at a single level will not reach a full class. Formative assessment research from Black and Wiliam backs the idea that a lesson's closing questions should push students to explain why something works, not just recite what it is called.

APPLICATION OF TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

Across eleven weeks of lesson notes with Form 1 and Form 2, covering hardware and software, Word, PowerPoint, and Excel, the same pattern held: demonstrate, then hand the keyboard over immediately. Lessons on formatting a document, building a "Myself" PowerPoint, or writing a nested IF formula in Excel all followed demonstration, guided practice, then an independent or group task, usually on something personally relevant: a birthday card, a family budget sheet, a list of favorite Ghanaian artists.

Mixed-ability, mixed-gender grouping was built into every lesson plan, with printed steps for students who needed more support and extension tasks, extra columns, harder conditions, additional formatting, for those who finished early. Each lesson closed with levelled questions rather than a single recap, so weaker and stronger students both had something to answer.

EFFECTIVENESS

The philosophy held up better in some areas than others.

What worked: supervisor feedback across the internship consistently noted clear, systematic delivery, good subject knowledge, and effective use of teaching aids, and students were visibly more engaged during hands-on tasks built around real data. Word's editing tools, PowerPoint's basic file handling, and Excel's core functions were all picked up well once students had something to practice on, and the recurring line in my own lesson reflections is some version of "goals largely achieved," which held across both form levels.

What did not: two pieces of supervisor feedback came up more than once and are worth taking seriously rather than explaining away. I was told to face the class while talking instead of the screen or board, and separately, that an explanation needed to be pitched closer to the students' own level rather than mine. Both point to the same gap: the philosophy is strong on structuring the activity, but I was not always as deliberate about how I communicated while running it. A more structural challenge also showed up repeatedly across weeks: limited laptops meant some students spent hands-on time watching a group-mate type rather than typing themselves, which works against the "learn by doing" belief at the centre of this philosophy.

Going into the classroom permanently, the fix is not a new philosophy but a tighter one. I am keeping the demonstrate-then-practice structure, and adding two habits I did not consistently have this term: checking my own language against how a Form 1 or 2 student would actually hear it, and giving every student in a shared-device group a real task, not just a seat.